

Joseph Reed Gaines

Software Engineer

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Professional Summary

Full-stack Software Engineer with 5 years of experience building high-performance, cross-platform web applications. Proven track record of optimizing React architectures for scale, implementing reusable, accessible, and responsive components, and driving exponential performance improvements. Experienced in maintaining strong test coverage, mentoring junior developers, and collaborating with product stakeholders to deliver polished user experiences. Integrates AI tooling end-to-end to accelerate development and ship high-quality software at competitive speeds.

Projects

Canteen (2025–Present): An app for storing and sharing recipes, built with an AI-augmented workflow, using GitHub Copilot and Claude Code to scaffold components, generate test cases, and speed up debugging, with every suggestion reviewed and revised by hand. The React frontend consumes Node.js/Express microservices with PostgreSQL databases, integrating a separate IAM service for cookie-based authentication, and backs up data to an S3 bucket via a nightly cron job. Deployed via a GitHub Actions CI/CD pipeline delivering Dockerized applications to a self-managed Kubernetes cluster (using Nginx Ingress) on Akamai Cloud.

Technical Skills

- **Languages:** JavaScript (ES6+), TypeScript, Java, Ruby, C#, HTML5, CSS3/SCSS, SQL
- **Frameworks & Libraries:** React, Node.js, Express, ASP.NET, Spring, Rails, Tailwind
- **Testing:** Jest, JUnit, Mockito, React Testing Library
- **AI-Assisted Development:** GitHub Copilot, Claude Code, Cursor, ChatGPT — used daily for scaffolding, debugging, and test generation, with manual review of all output
- **Tools & Platforms:** Git/GitHub, Docker, AWS, Postgres, Zendesk Themes, CI/CD Pipelines
- **Key Competencies:** Performance Optimization, Responsive Design, Accessibility

Experience

Windham NE Supervisory Union, Windham, VT · *Substitute Teacher* · Oct 2025 – June 2026

- Taught classes of up to 30 students, of any subject, on an as-needed basis.
- Delivered daily lesson plans and synthesized and reported pedagogical outcomes.

Squarespace, New York, NY · *Software Engineer* · September 2021 – September 2024

- Delivered production code daily for the Squarespace Help Center and core product, ensuring consistent rendering across desktop, tablet, and mobile web environments.
- Wrote and verified unit tests, using Jest for React frontend components and JUnit/Mockito for Java backend services, ensuring >90% code coverage.

- Collaborated with designers and product owners to architect and implement a new AI-powered support chatbot. Built complex live-support handoff flows, directly supporting company initiatives to leverage AI for user productivity.
- Implemented a comprehensive redesign of home and article pages. Added content placeholders to minimize layout shift, significantly improving core web vitals.

Econify, New York, NY · *Software Engineer* · May 2019 – September 2021

- Developed a revamped article and buyer's guide platform for MotorTrend. Optimized critical rendering paths to increase page performance by a factor of 10, achieving top-tier rankings on web performance benchmarks.
- Delivered daily deployments for high-traffic media clients. Streamlined third-party ad implementations, increasing viewability by 400% and directly driving revenue.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to manage a range of full-stack services from Postgres databases to React frontends.

Pursuit, New York, NY · *Head of Web Instruction / Lead Instructor* · Nov 2017 – May 2019

- Led three cohorts of approx. 35 adult engineers-in-training through an immersive 10-month full-stack development program (PERN stack).
- Oversaw curriculum development and code reviews, establishing strict standards for clean, maintainable code and modern version control practices.
- Mentored junior developers on debugging, problem-solving strategies, and career readiness, fostering a culture of continuous learning and collaboration.

University of Wisconsin, Madison, WI · *Assoc. Uni. Relations Specialist* · Dec 2016 – Jul 2017

- Disseminated and implemented a landmark qualitative study and information module on young adults with depression.
- Managed content editorial, web promotion, and website design, and analyzed web traffic and user feedback.
- Coordinated promotional efforts onsite at national mental health conferences.

Google, Ann Arbor, MI · *Associate Account Strategist* · Aug 2013 – Aug 2014

- Consulted with account managers to refine online marketing strategies, maintaining a customer satisfaction rate of over 90 percent.

Education

App Academy, New York, NY · 2017

- 1000-hour immersive full-stack web development course (3% acceptance rate).

Brown University, Providence, RI · *MFA, Digital Language Arts* · 2014 – 2016

- Designed and taught two undergraduate Digital Language Arts courses during second year of the program.

Vassar College, Poughkeepsie, NY · *BA, English* · 2009 – 2013

- Graduated with Honors.